

Custodian Tea Cup

Player-facing description

Custodian Tea Cup: A tea ring on a denial letter that makes the Custodian's exhaustion visible before exposition.

Public role

Quiet sign of repeated worry inside the Hanging Office

Handout text

Player-safe note: A tea ring on a denial letter that makes the Custodian's exhaustion visible before exposition.

GM truth

No forced reveal. Let this entity disclose truth through scene context and player attention.

GM handling

Use when the scene needs a concrete object for players to inspect, carry, debate, or remember.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn Custodian Tea Cup when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: A tea ring on a denial letter that makes the Custodian's exhaustion visible before exposition. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-custodian-tea-cup-engage-custodian-tea-cup entity-custodian-tea-cup Engage Custodian Tea Cup Engage Custodian Tea Cup Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of Custodian Tea Cup hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a...
- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal

without closing off player agency.

- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Not treasure; it tells the GM to play the Custodian as a person under pressure.

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